Choosing a Rails Version

The previous instructions helped you install the version of Rails used by the examples in this book. But, occasionally, you might not want to run that version. For example, a newer version with some fixes or new features might become available. Or, perhaps, you're developing on one machine but intending to deploy on another machine that contains a version of Rails that you don't have any control over.

If either of these situations applies to you, you need to be aware of a few things. For starters, you can use the `gem` command to find all the versions of Rails you have installed:

```
$ gem list --local rails
```

You can also verify which version of Rails you're running as the default by using the `rails --version` command. It should return 8.0.2.

If it doesn't, start by inserting the version of Rails surrounded by underscores before the first parameter of any `rails` command. Here's an example:

```
$ rails _8.0.2_ --version
```

What this will do is generate a file named `Gemfile` in the current directory with the following contents:

```
gem "rails", "~> 8.0.2"
```

That strange syntax is called a *twiddle-wakka*,[28] or (more formally) the pessimistic version operator, and it means that you're asking for the latest version of Rails that's compatible with 8.0.2.

To upgrade, simply update the version number in the `Gemfile` that's in the root directory of your application and run `bundle install`. You can also pin to a